

Daniel J. Singer

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Employment

Current

Associate Professor of Philosophy University of Pennsylvania	<i>July 2019 –</i>
Associate Professor of Legal Studies & Business Ethics (Secondary) Wharton School of Business	<i>July 2021 –</i>

Past

Consultant, Boston Consulting Group	<i>Aug. 2022 – Aug. 2024</i>
Chair of Undergraduate Philosophy, University of Pennsylvania	<i>July 2021 – June 2022</i>
Assistant Professor of Philosophy, University of Pennsylvania	<i>Jan. 2013 – June 2019</i>
Institute for Cross-Disciplinary Engagement Fellow, Dartmouth College	<i>Spring 2018</i>

Specializations: Philosophy of Work, Philosophy of AI, Epistemology, Ethics

Add. Interests: Business Ethics; Social Philosophy; Philosophy of Science

Education

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

Ph.D. in Philosophy	<i>December 2012</i>
M.A. in Philosophy	<i>2010</i>

Visiting Student in Philosophy, RSSS, Australian National University	<i>2010, 2012</i>
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University of Pennsylvania

B.A. in Logic, Information, and Computation and Philosophy (Honors)	<i>2008</i>
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Publications

Books

<i>What's the Point of Employment?</i>	<i>In development</i>
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This work-in-progress argues that employment should be seen as a major institution in society, akin to a police force or an educational system. Understood this way, employment stands in need of a justification that's acceptable to owners, managers, and employees alike. The purpose of employment, I argue, is to increase productive efficiency while also providing both pecuniary and non-pecuniary goods to workers. This approach to thinking about employment offers a new conception of the institution while also unifying disparate debates in business, philosophy of work, and business ethics, offering a cohesive framework for understanding topics including the nature of the firm and what makes a job good or meaningful.

Books (*continued*)

Right Belief and True Belief 2023
Oxford University Press, New York

Right Belief and True Belief likens work in epistemology about what we should believe to work in normative ethics about what we should do. It uses that analogy to draw out a methodology for epistemology that's centered around the question of what we should believe, and it defends a truth-loving consequentialist answer to that question. In doing so, the book sets the stage for a deeply truth-guided approach to all aspects of epistemology.

Articles

"Should Employees Have Voice at Work?" *In preparation*

"Employment is a Relationship, Not an Exchange" *In preparation*

"What is AI Slop (and Why It Matters)" *In preparation*

"The Future of AI Is Many, Not One" *Under Review*
with Garzino Demo
Preprint available here: arxiv.org/abs/2603.29075

"The Epistemic Advantages of Representative Deliberation" *Under Review*
with Berger, Grim, Bramson, Holman, and Jung

"It's Not Always Wrong to Gaslight Employees" *Under review*

"How Diversity Helps Jury Decisions" *Forthcoming*
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger
in *Agent-Based Modeling for Research on Groups, Networks, and Organizations*, James R. Larson, Corinne Coen (eds.), American Psychological Association

"The Epistemic Role of Diversity in Juries: An Agent-Based Model" 2024
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger
in *Journal of Artificial Societies and Social Simulation*

"Philosophical Considerations of Political Polarization" 2022
with Berger, Bramson, Grim, Holman, and Jung
in *The Political Turn in Analytic Philosophy: Reflections on Social Injustice and Oppressions*, Bordonaba Plou, Fernández Castro, and Ramoñ Torices (eds.)

"Epistemic Networks and Polarization" 2021
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger
in *The Routledge Handbook of Political Epistemology*, Hannon and de Ridder (eds.)

- “Don’t Forget Forgetting: The Epistemic Importance of How We Forget”** 2021
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, Kovaka, and Berger
in *Synthese*
- Review of Sanford Goldberg’s *To the Best of Our Knowledge*** 2021
in *Philosophical Review*
- “What Epistemic Reasons are For: Against the Belief–Sandwich Distinction”** 2021
with Sara Aronowitz
in *Meaning, Decision, and Norms: Themes from the Work of Allan Gibbard, Billy Dunaway and David Plunkett* (eds.)
- “Computational Philosophy”** 2020
with Patrick Grim
Entry in the *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*
- “Representation in Models of Epistemic Democracy”** 2020
with Grim, Bramson, Berger, Jung, and Page
in *Episteme*
- “Demoting Promoting Objections to Epistemic Consequentialism”** 2019
in *Philosophical Issues*
- “A Multidisciplinary Understanding of Polarization”** 2019
with Jung, Grim, Bramson, Berger, Holman, and Kovaka
in *American Psychologist*
- “Diversity, Not Randomness, Trumps Ability”** 2019
in *Philosophy of Science*
- “Rational Social and Political Polarization”** 2019
with Bramson, Grim, Holman, Jung, Kovaka, Ranginani, and Berger
in *Philosophical Studies*
- “Diversity, Ability, and Expertise in Epistemic Communities”** 2019
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, McGeehan, and Berger
in *Philosophy of Science*
- “Permissible Epistemic Trade-offs”** 2018
in *The Australasian Journal of Philosophy*
- “Diversity and Democracy: Agent-based Modeling in Political Philosophy”** 2018
with Holman, Berger, Grim, and Bramson
in *Historical Social Research*

- "How to be an Epistemic Consequentialist"** 2018
in *Philosophical Quarterly*
- "Understanding Polarization: Meanings, Measures, and Model Evaluation"** 2017
with Grim, Bramson, Berger, Sack, Fisher, and Flocken,
in *Philosophy of Science*, Vol. 84, No. 1, p. 115-159
- "Disambiguation of Social Polarization Concepts and Measures"** 2016
with Bramson, Grim, Fisher, Sack, Berger, and Flocken
in *The Journal of Mathematical Sociology*, Vol. 40, Issue 2, p. 80-111
- "Mind the Is-Ought Gap"** 2015
in *The Journal of Philosophy*, Volume 112, Issue 4, p. 193-210
- "Germs, Genes, and Memes:
Function and Fitness Dynamics on Information Networks"** 2015
with Grim, Fisher, and Reade
in *Philosophy of Science*, Vol. 82, No. 2, p. 219-243
- "Sleeping Beauty Should be Imprecise"** 2014
in *Synthese*, Volume 191, Issue 14, p. 3159-3172
- "Scientific Networks on Data Landscapes:
Question Difficulty, Epistemic Success, and Convergence"** 2013
with Grim, Fisher, Bramson, Berger, Reade, Flocken, and Sales
in *Episteme*, Volume 10, Number 4, p. 441-464
- "Philosophical Analysis in Modeling Polarization:
Notes from a Work in Progress"** 2012
with Grim, Bramson, Fisher, Flocken, and Berger
in the APA Newsletter on Philosophy and Computers, Vol. 12, No. 1, p. 7-15
Updated and reprinted in Youngman and Hadzikadic (Editors), *Complexity and the Human Experience: Modeling Complexity in the Humanities and Social Sciences*, Pan Stanford Press, 2014
- "Polarization and Belief Dynamics in the Black and White Communities:
An Agent-Based Network Model from the Data"** 2012
with Grim, Thomas, Reade, Fisher, Reade, Garza, Fryer and Chatman
in *Artificial Life* 13, p. 186-193
- "Information Dynamics Across Linked Sub-Networks:
Genes, Germs, and Memes"** 2011
with Grim, Reade, and Fisher
in *Proceedings, AAAI Fall Symposium on Complex Systems*

- “What You Believe Travels Differently:
Information and Infection Dynamics Across Sub-Networks”** 2010
with Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz
in *Connections*, Vol. 30, No. 2, p. 50-63
- “Robustness Across the Structure of Sub-Networks:
The Contrast Between Infection and Information Dynamics”** 2010
with Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz
in *Proceedings, AAAI Fall Symposium on Complex Systems*

Grants, Awards, and Honors

- Google Research Award for Project on AI Innovation (\$10,000)** 2025
- Penn Mellon Fellow and Provost’s Leadership Academy Participant** 2021
- Dean’s Award for Distinguished Teaching by an Assistant Professor** 2018
Penn’s School of Arts and Sciences award that recognizes one member
of the junior faculty who demonstrates unusual promise as an educator
- Price Lab for the Digital Humanities Mellon Faculty Fellow** 2016 – 2018
- SCEW (MindCORE) Grant for Agent-Based Modeling Workshop (\$6K)** Spring 2020
- GPPC Conference Grants for PeRFECt (\$3K, \$2K, \$3K, \$2.5K, \$1K)** 2014 – 2019
- SAS Conference Support Grants (\$3K, \$3K, \$2K, \$3K)** Spring 2015, 2017, 2018, 2020
- University Research Foundation Grants (\$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000)** Spring 2015, 2017, 2020
- SAS Research Opportunity Grant (\$3,000)** Spring 2017
- University Research and Dean’s Grants for PRPSEW (\$4,900, \$5,000)** Spring 2014, 2017
- Penn Provost Excellence through Diversity Grant for PeRFECt2 (\$4,000)** Fall 2016
- Penn Undergraduate Research Mentorship (PURM) Grant (\$5,300)** Summer 2016
- Penn Digital Humanities Forum Project Incubation Grant (\$3,000)** Summer 2015
- Rackham International Research Grant** Summer 2012

Wirt and Mary Cornwell Prize Fellowship	2011-2012
Prize for outstanding intellectual curiosity and exceptional promise of original study and creative work in Philosophy	
Rackham Graduate School Research Grant	Summer 2010
Rackham Graduate School Travel Grants	2009, 2010, 2012
Marshall M. Weinberg Summer Fellowship	Summer 2009
Prize for academic distinction during early years of graduate study	
University of Michigan Philosophy Department Fellowship	2009, 2010, 2011
University of Michigan Summer Research Grant	2009, 2010, 2011

Selected Presentations and Conference Organization

The Future of AI is Many, Not One	
Presented at Hong Kong University	March 2026
What's the Point of Employment?	
Presented at Denison University	March 2026
Presented at Hong Kong University	March 2026
Managerial (Over)control and Why It Matters for Firms and Employees	
Presented at PPE Society Conference, New Orleans	November 2025
It's Not Always Wrong to Gaslight Employees	
Presented at Work and Democracy Workshop, Groningen	October 2025
Presented at PPE Society Conference, London	July 2025
The Employment Tax on Agency and Managerial Gaslighting	
Presented at University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill	March 2025
Philosopher Meets Critics: <i>Right Belief and True Belief</i>	
Online discussion with Ram Neta, Amy Flowerree, and Kate Nolfi	Nov. 2024
Hosted by CONCEPT (University of Cologne) & Federal University of Bahia	
Available online at http://youtu.be/sGb4FZNIm0o	
Author Meets Critics: <i>Right Belief and True Belief</i>	
Discussion with Ram Neta, Amy Flowerree, and Kate Nolfi	
Presented at the Eastern APA in New York	Jan. 2024

How Management Affects Diversity

Presented at Boston Consulting Group

*May 2024***Psychological Safety Levels the Playing Field for Employees**

Presented at Boston Consulting Group

*May 2023***Modelling the Epistemic Effects of Diversity and Enclaves**

Presented at Hong Kong University

*April 2022***The Epistemic Role of Diversity in Juries**

Presented at Wharton School of Business

*May 2021***Should Juries be Unanimous?**

Presented at University of Southern California

*September 2020***Jury Unanimity: An Agent-Based Model Approach**

Presented at Social (Distance) Epistemology Workshop

May 2020

Presented at University of Pennsylvania

*September 2019***Agent-Based Models of *Is* and *Ought***

Keynote at “ABMs of Scientific Inquiry,” Bochum, Germany

*March 2019***Knowledge for Epistemic Consequentialists**

Presented at Fordham University

*October 2018***Models and Target Systems in Normative Inquiry**

Presented at Hebrew University’s “Modeling Reality Workshop”

*July 2018***Rational Polarization and the Importance of Group ‘Forgets’**

Presented at Dartmouth College

April 2018

Publicly Accessible Version Presented at Dartmouth ICE

*May 2018***Epistemic Consequentialism**

Presented at the University of Vermont

*May 2018***Penn Reasons and Foundations in Epistemology Conference (PeRFECT)***2015 – 2018*

Organizer with Errol Lord and Lisa Miracchi

Permissible Epistemic Trade-offs

Presented at Chapel Hill Normativity Workshop

*March 2018***Rational Polarization and the Importance of Forgetting**

Presented at Dept. of Legal Studies and Business Ethics, Wharton

February 2018

Group Polarization as a Limitedly Rational Response to Evidence

Presented at Price Lab for the Digital Humanities, Penn

October 2017

Presented at Decisions, Games and Logic, University of Michigan

*July 2016***Models of Group Deliberation: Thick and Thin**Keynote at DebateLab Workshop on Argumentation in Opinion Dynamics,
KIT, Karlsruhe, Germany*June 2017*

Presented at DiMiNet, Annenberg School of Communication

*October 2017***Penn-Rutgers-Princeton Social Epistemology Workshop***2013-2017*

Lead Organizer, Spring 2014, Spring 2017

Organizer, Spring 2013, Spring 2015, Spring 2016

Sophisticated Epistemic Consequentialism

Presented at Dartmouth

January 2016

Presented at Institut Jean Nicod, Paris FR

June 2016

Presented at the University of British Columbia

*November 2016***Normative and Scientific Explanation**

Presented at the Eastern APA in Washington DC

January 2016

Presented at the Ethics and Explanation Conference, Nottingham UK

*February 2016***Votes, Talk, and Groups: Modeling Epistemic Democracy and Polarization**

Presented at Sawyer Seminar on Trust, Northwestern University

*May 2015***Symposium: Computer Simulations in Philosophical Research**

Presented at the Eastern APA in Philadelphia, PA

*December 2014***Why Believe the Truth**

Presented as a PhilSoc at the Australian National University

July 2012

Presented at the USC/UCLA Graduate Conference

March 2012

Presented at the Yale/UConn Graduate Conference

*April 2012***Modeling Peer Disagreement**

Presented at the Australasian Association of Philosophy Meeting

*June 2012***Grounding Epistemology in Belief**

Presented at the University of Pennsylvania

*April 2012***Information Dynamics Across Sub-networks:****Germes, Genes, and Memes**

With Grim, Fisher, and Reade

Presented at the AAAI Fall Symposium Series

November 2011

The Is-Ought Gap Gap

Presented at the Michigan Graduate Student Working Group

*December 2010***Robustness Across the Structure of Sub-Networks:****The Contrast Between Infection and Information Dynamics**

With Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz

Presented at the AAAI Fall Symposium Series

*November 2010***Some Problems for Imprecise Bayesianism**

Presented at the Australasian Association of Philosophy Conference

*July 2010***Epistemic Conservatism for Imprecise Partial Belief**

Presented at the Notre Dame/Northwestern Epistemology Conference

March 2010

Presented at the Princeton-Rutgers Graduate Conference

*April 2010***On James Harrington's "Instants and Instantaneous Velocity"**

Comments presented at the Eastern APA Symposium

*December 2009***On the Use of Isomorphisms in an Account of Similarity**

Presented at the Formal Methods in Philosophy Conference, Penn

*May 2008***Selected Professional and Academic Service**

Editor, *The Philosopher's Annual**2026 – Present***Chair of Graduate Admissions, Penn Philosophy***2024 – Present***Member, Penn Presidential Commission on Open Expression***2024 – 2025***Undergraduate Chair, Penn Philosophy***2021 – 2022***Penn Arts and Sciences Curriculum Committee**

Chair

2019 – 2022

Member

*2018 – 2022***Penn Arts and Sciences Committee to Revise Curricular Review**

Chair

*2019 – 2021***Penn Arts and Sciences Committee on Undergraduate Education**

Ex-Officio Member

2019 – 2022

Penn Faculty Senate Executive Committee Member	
Representative from Philosophy and Linguistics	2018 – 2022
Assistant Professor Representative	2015 – 2017
Representative to Greater Phila. Philosophy Consortium	2019 – 2021
Placement Director, Penn Philosophy	2013 – 2020
Penn Fraternity and Sorority Advisory Board	2018 – 2019
Steering Committee, Social Epistemology Network	2017 – Present
SAS Planning Group on Quantitative Explorations of Evolving Systems	2015 – 2018
Residential Faculty Fellow, Ware College House	2014 – 2018
Phi Beta Kappa Election Committee	2015 – 2017
NEH Institute - Computer Simulations in the Humanities	June 2011
Experienced Modelling Mentor at the NEH Institute for Advanced Topics in the Digital Humanities at the University of North Carolina at Charlotte	

Teaching

As Primary Instructor

Introduction to Mathematical Logic (Grad and Undergrad)	<i>Spr. '26, '25, '20, '15</i>
Graduate Seminar on Philosophy of Work	<i>Spring '26</i>
Knowledge and Reality	<i>F '25, F '24, F '22, F '19, F '18, Spr. '16, F '14, F '13</i>
Undergrad Seminar on AI in Work, School, and Research	<i>Fall '25</i>
Business Ethics & Social Responsibility (Wharton)	<i>Spring '25</i>
Graduate Seminar on Meaningful Work	<i>Spring '25</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Architectures	<i>Fall '24</i>
Graduate Seminar on the Value of Diversity	<i>Fall '22</i>
Introduction to Philosophy	<i>Fall '21, Spr. '19, Fall '17, Fall '15, Spr. '14</i>
Dissertation Writing Workshop	<i>Fall '21, Fall '17, Fall '13</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Normativity and Consequentialism	<i>Spring '21</i>
Graduate Seminar on Legal Epistemology	<i>Spring '20</i>
Food and Fat (Seminar on Ethics of Obesity)	<i>Fall '19, Spring '16</i>
Scientific Reasoning (Undergrad Online)	<i>Fall '19, Spring '20</i>
Graduate Seminar on the Domain of Epistemology	<i>Spring '19</i>
Graduate Proseminar	<i>Fall '18, '15, '14</i>
Graduate Seminar on Normativity in Formal Epistemology	<i>Fall '17</i>
Graduate Seminar on Social Epistemology	<i>Spring '17</i>

Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Reasons	<i>Spring '15</i>
Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Normativity	<i>Spring '14</i>
Graduate Seminar on Williamson's <i>Knowledge and its Limits</i>	<i>Spring '13</i>
Epistemology (Undergraduate Introduction)	<i>Spring '13</i>
Problems of Philosophy	<i>Spring '12</i>
Introduction to Logic (with Online Component)	<i>Summer '11</i>

University of Michigan Graduate Teacher Certificate 2012

Teaching and professional development, including courses and research on teaching, class feedback sessions and evaluations, and a teaching mentorship.

As Graduate Student Instructor

Philosophy of Mind and Language, Eric Swanson	<i>Spring '11</i>
Applied Ethics, Sarah Buss	<i>Spring '10</i>
Mathematical Logic, Richmond Thomason	<i>Fall '09</i>

As Teaching Intern and Grader

Mathematical Logic, David Baker	<i>Fall '08, Spring '09</i>
Introduction to Logic, Scott Weinstein	<i>Spring '07, Spring '08</i>